

Standard Operating Procedure

Critical Imaging Result Communication

«Hospital Name» — Supports AAC.8.f

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» communicates a critical imaging finding the moment the report is ready, with a documented read-back.

2. Scope

Applies to every radiologist or authorised reporter, for every modality with a defined critical-result category, including outsourced and teleradiology reports.

3. Responsibility

Reporting Radiologist / Authorised Reporter: identifies the critical finding and calls it in immediately.

Receiving Clinical Staff: reads back the finding to confirm accuracy.

4. Procedure

1. Check every completed study against the documented critical-result definitions for that modality.
2. The moment a critical finding is identified, call a person from the treating team immediately — do not wait for routine report distribution.
3. State clearly: patient name, unique ID, date and time of imaging, investigation name, and the finding.
4. Ask the recipient to read back the finding to confirm it was heard correctly, and log that the read-back was done.
5. Record your identity and the recipient's identity in the Critical Imaging Result Communication Log, with date and time.

5. Records

Supported by Records 16–18 of the AAC.8 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_AAC_8_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — AAC.8 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually.

8. References

- The Joint Commission. (2026). National Patient Safety Goals: Report critical results of tests and diagnostic procedures on a timely basis (Goal NPSG.02.03.01). <https://www.jointcommission.org/en-us/standards/national-patient-safety-goals>
- American College of Radiology. (n.d.). ACR practice parameter for communication of diagnostic imaging findings. <https://www.acr.org/-/media/ACR/Files/Practice-Parameters/CommunicationDiag.pdf>